

DATE:
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PRESENTED BY:
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PROJECT MANAGEMENT
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RUCONNECTED

A Centralized Digital Platform for Rutgers Students.



SIJASOLUTIONS@GMAIL.COM



“TECHNOLOGY IS BEST WHEN IT
BRINGS PEOPLE TOGETHER.”

~**MATT MULLENWEG**
(FOUNDER OF WORDPRESS)

OVERVIEW



OVERVIEW



- **UNIFIED STUDENT PLATFORM**
- **CENTRALIZED COMMUNICATION & RESOURCES**
- **DESIGNED TO IMPROVE CONNECTION AND ACCESSIBILITY AT RUTGERS**

OUR TEAM



S
I
J
A



SHASHANK KAMBLE
PROJECT FACILITATOR

S
|
J
A



| INIYA ARASU
PROJECT MANAGER

S
I
J
A



JOHANN TORRES
IMPLEMENTATION LEAD

S
I
J
A



ABDUL RAHMAN
PROJECT ADMINISTRATOR



THE PROBLEM

- STUDENT COMMUNICATION IS SCATTERED ACROSS MULTIPLE UNOFFICIAL APPS.
- RESOURCES ARE HARD TO FIND AND INCONSISTENT ACROSS CAMPUSES.
- NO UNIFIED SPACE FOR ACADEMIC, COMMUTER, AND WELLNESS SUPPORT.



Passio GO!
Passio Technologies Inc



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IMPACT:

- STUDENTS MISS IMPORTANT INFORMATION.
- REDUCED COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT.
- INEFFICIENT ACCESS TO UNIVERSITY SERVICES.

WHY DOES THIS MATTER?



THE SOLUTION

- SECURE RUTGERS SSO ACCESS
- CHAT + CHANNELS
- COMMUTER HUB
- STUDENT MARKETPLACE
- WELLNESS CENTER
- DIGITAL BULLETIN BOARD
- ADMIN DASHBOARD



A CENTRALIZED DIGITAL PLATFORM FOR RUTGERS STUDENTS.

WHY OUR SOLUTION WORKS:

1

DESIGNED
AROUND REAL
STUDENT NEEDS

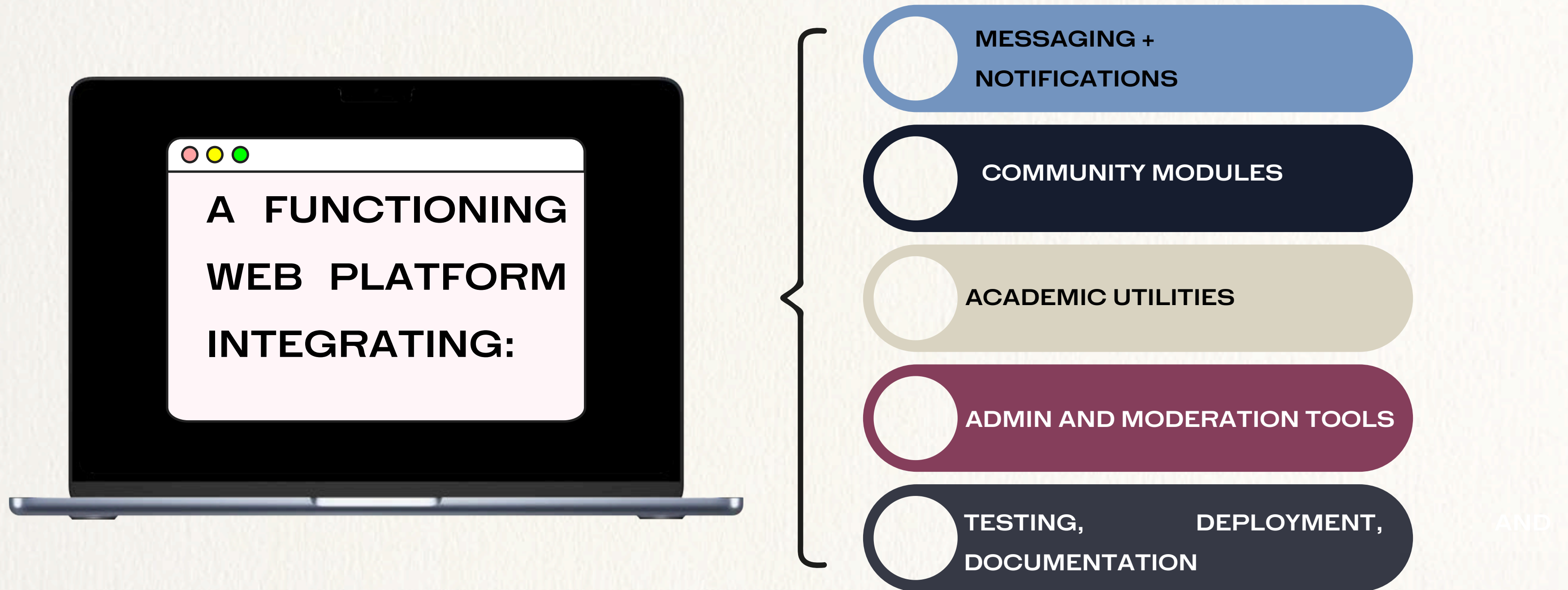
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INTEGRATES
MULTIPLE TOOLS
INTO ONE PLACE

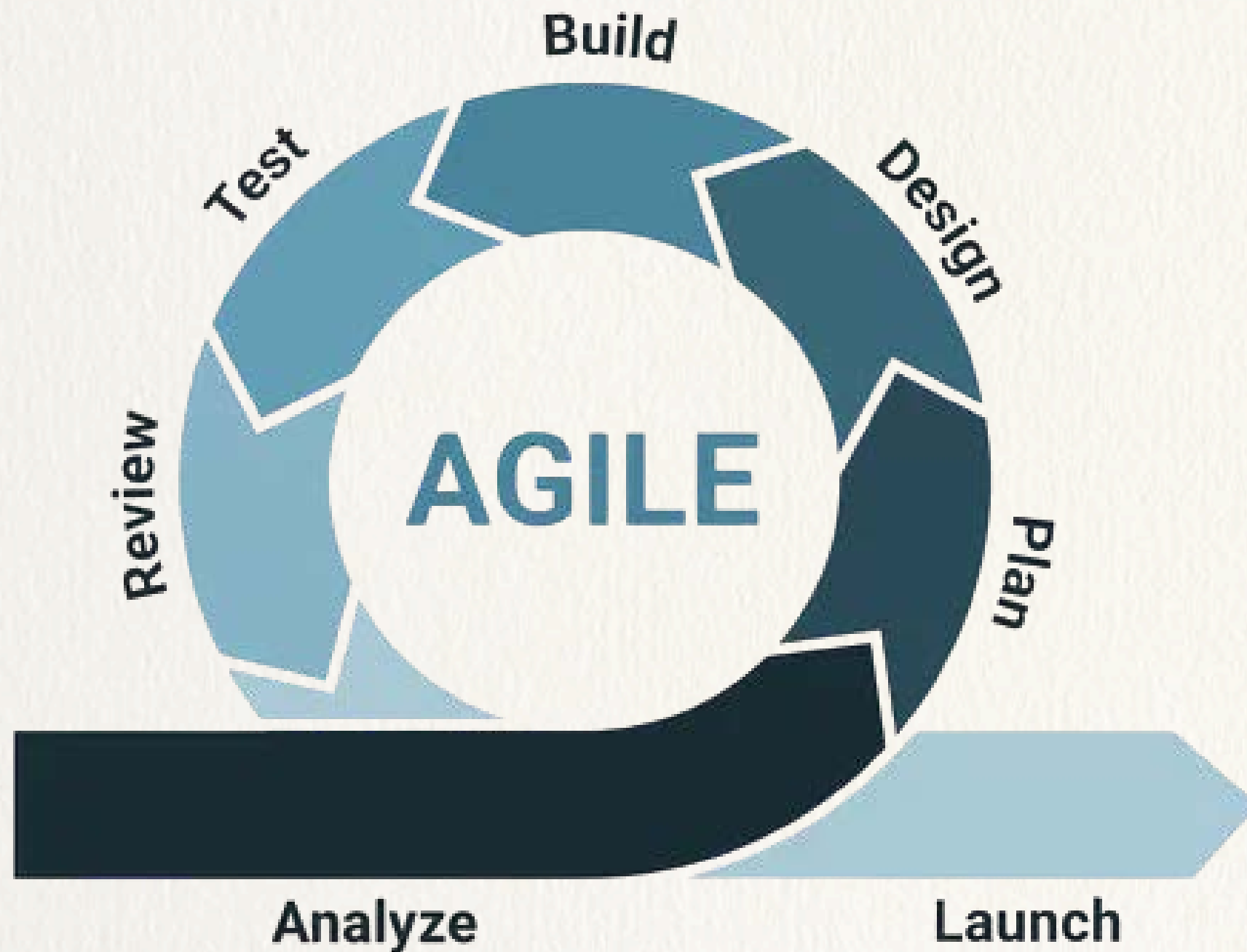
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SECURE, SCALABLE,
AND UNIVERSITY-
SUPPORTED

PRIMARY DELIVERABLE



PROJECT MANAGEMENT LIFECYCLE



- SHORT ITERATIVE SPRINTS
- EARLY PROTOTYPE TESTING
- FAST FEEDBACK CYCLES
- FLEXIBLE SCOPE CHANGES
- IDEAL FOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT



ANALYTIC PLAN

QUANTITATIVE



ACTIVE USERS

MEASURES HOW MANY STUDENTS REGULARLY USE THE PLATFORM



ENGAGEMENT METRICS

TRACKS HOW OFTEN STUDENTS INTERACT WITH FEATURES



BUG COUNT

MONITORS SYSTEM ISSUES TO EVALUATE TECHNICAL STABILITY AND QUALITY



SURVEYS NAME

COLLECTS STUDENT OPINIONS TO UNDERSTAND SATISFACTION AND USABILITY.

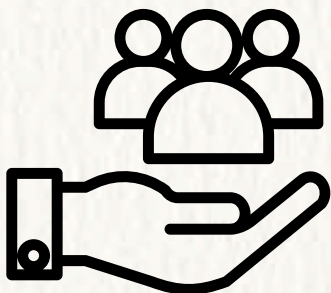


USABILITY FEEDBACK

IDENTIFIES HOW EASY OR DIFFICULT THE PLATFORM FEELS FOR STUDENTS TO NAVIGATE.

QUALITATIVE

STAKEHOLDERS



SIJA SOLUTIONS (PROJECT TEAM)



STUDENTS



DEAN OF STUDENTS



STUDENT AFFAIRS



WELLNESS AND MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES



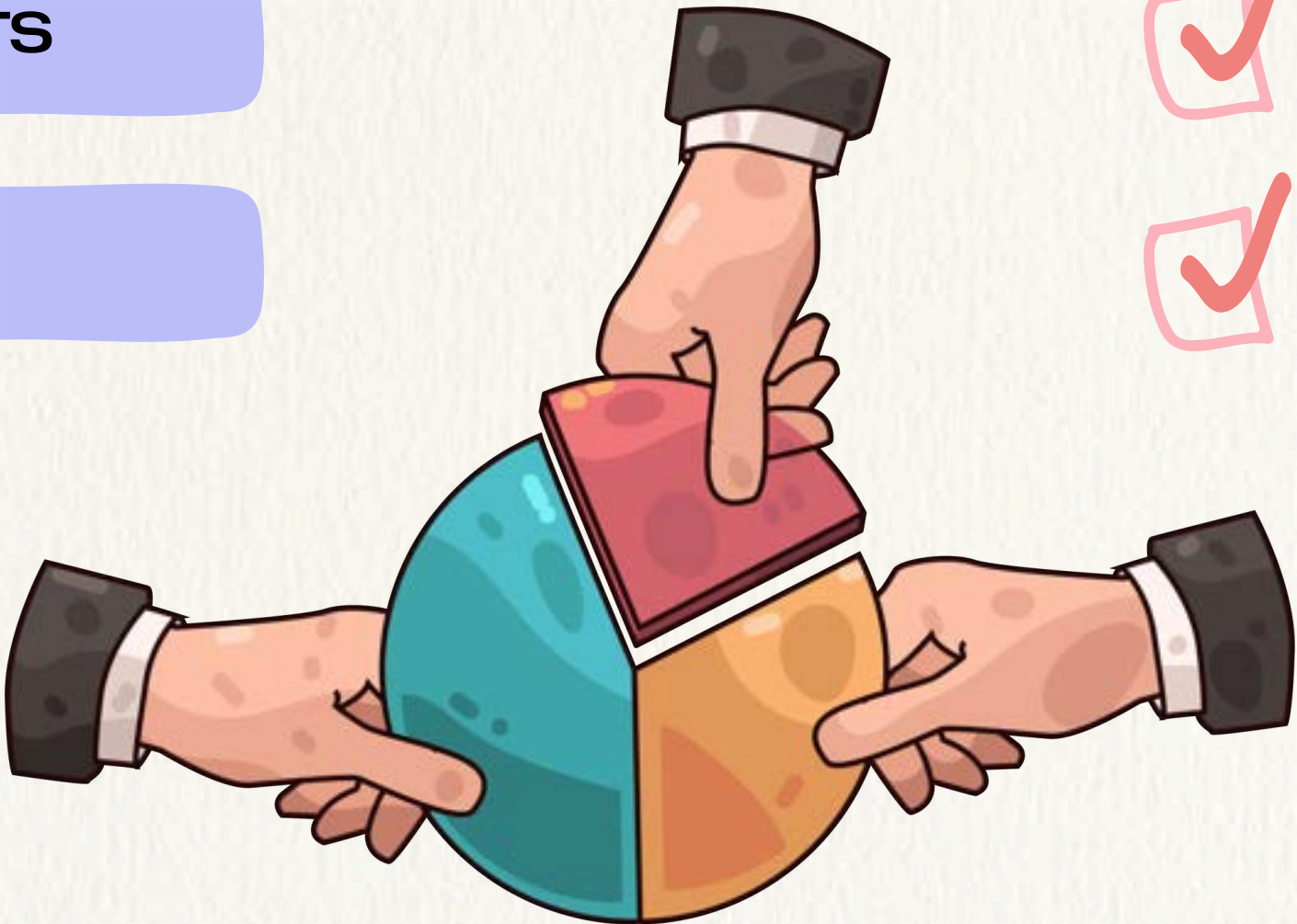
STUDENTS



RUTGERS IT DEPARTMENT

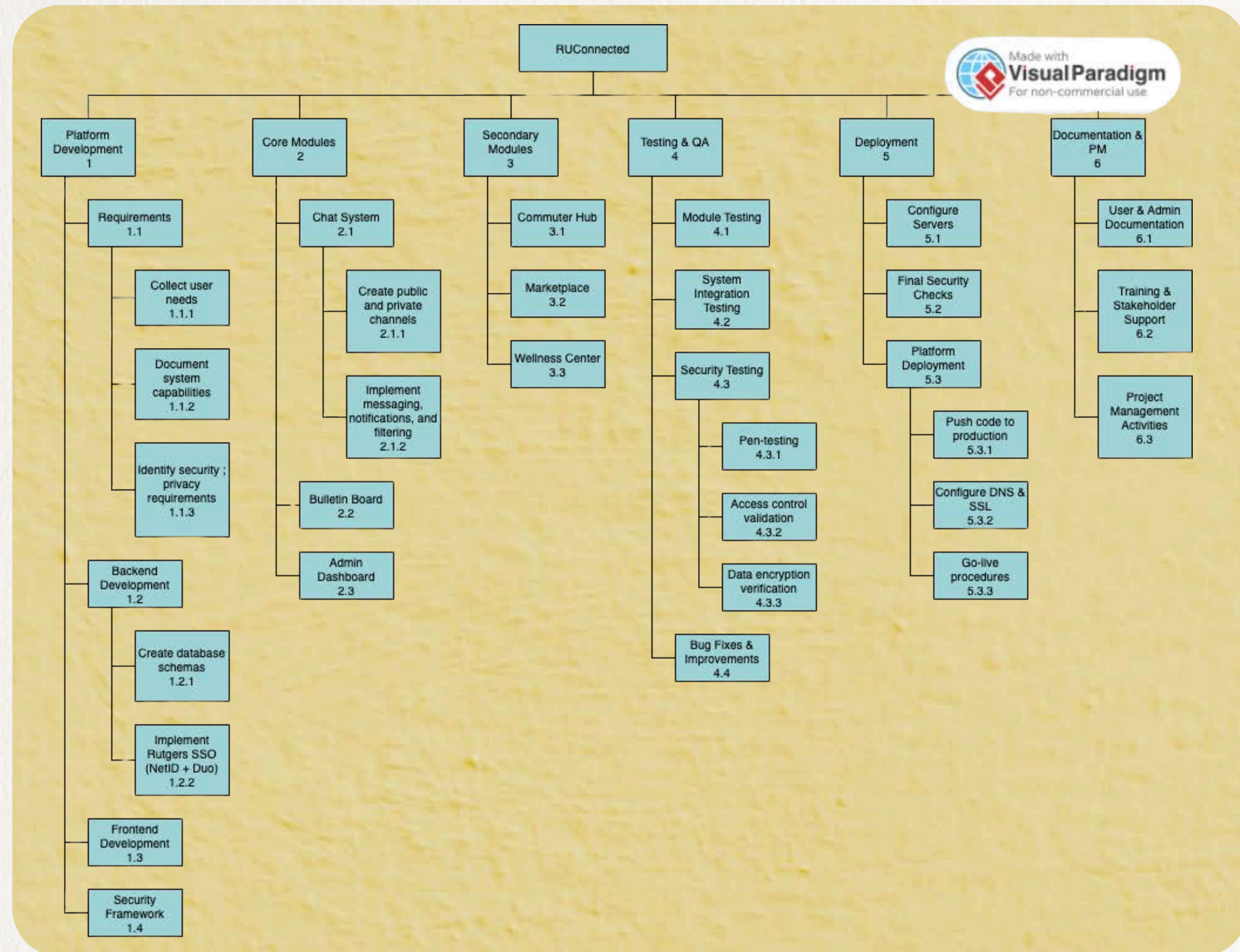
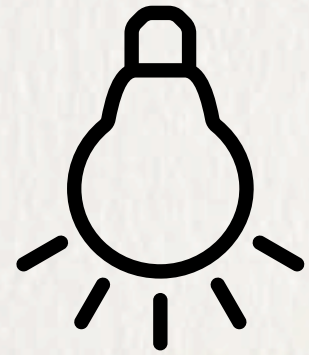


COMMUTER SERVICES



WBS

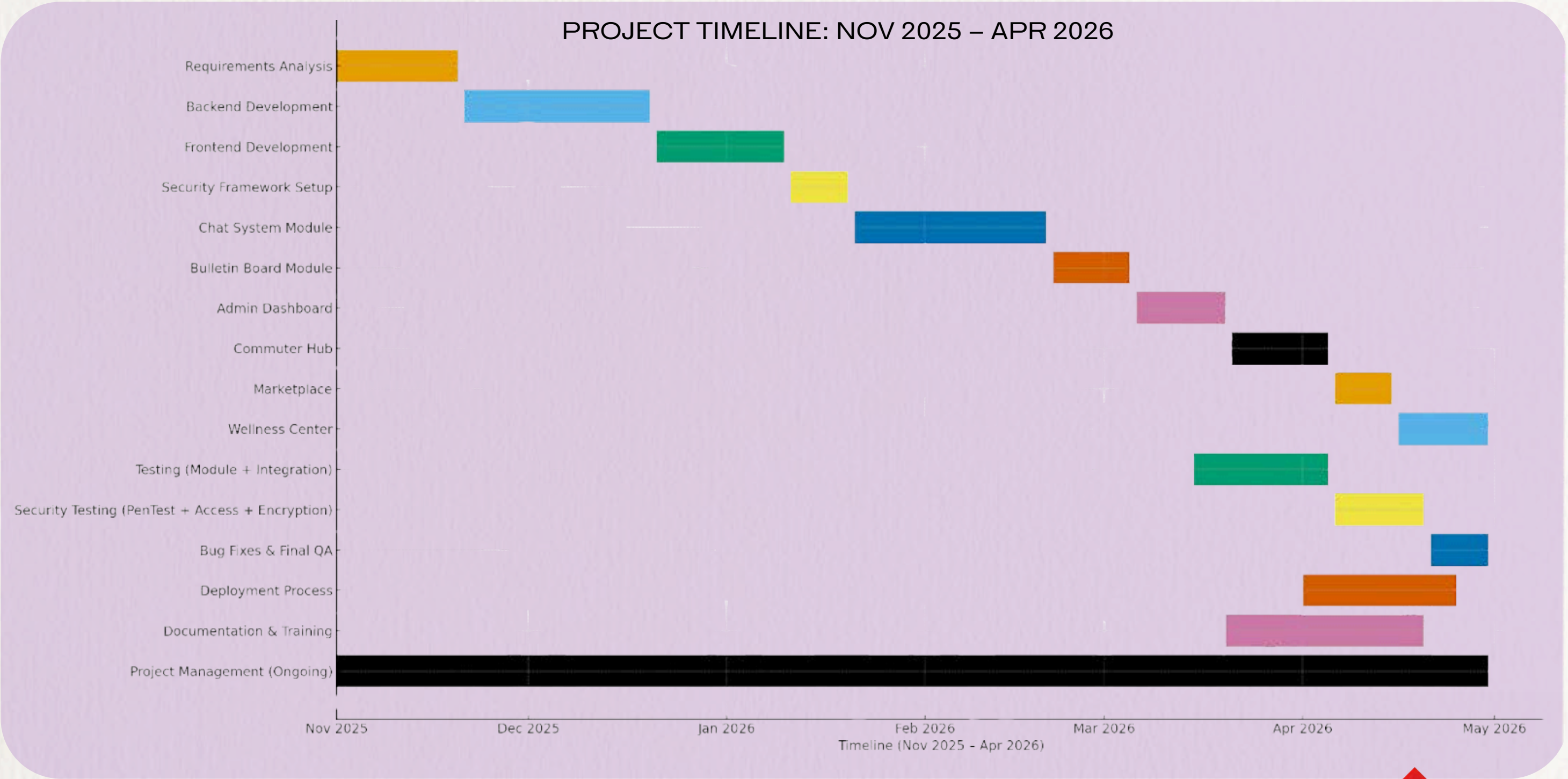
(WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE)



TIMELINE

PHASES:

- REQUIREMENTS
- DEVELOPMENT
- MODULES
- TESTING
- DEPLOYMENT
- DOCUMENTATION



RESOURCES

BUDGET

\$500,000

SUPPLIES

LICENSES, TESTING TOOLS,
DOCUMENTATION MATERIALS

TEAM

PM, DEVS, ADMIN,
QA, FACILITATOR

TOOLS

CLOUD HOSTING,
APIS, DESIGN TOOLS

SUPPORT

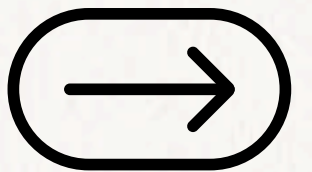
STUDENT PILOT TESTERS,
DOCUMENTATION TOOLS

INFRASTRUCTURE

SERVERS, STORAGE, VPN,
TEST DEVICES



RISK MANAGEMENT



1. LOW STUDENT ADOPTION

STUDENTS MAY NOT SWITCH FROM EXISTING UNOFFICIAL PLATFORMS.

MITIGATION:

- CONDUCT EARLY PILOT TESTING
- GATHER FEEDBACK AND REFINE FEATURES BASED ON ACTUAL USAGE
- PROMOTE THE PLATFORM THROUGH ORIENTATION, COMMUTER PROGRAMS, AND STUDENT ORGS



2. INTEGRATION & TECHNICAL DELAYS

DEPENDENCIES ON RUTGERS IT, SSO, AND BACKEND SYSTEMS MAY SLOW DEVELOPMENT.

MITIGATION:

- SCHEDULE REGULAR SYNCs WITH RUTGERS IT TEAMS
- ALLOCATE BUFFER TIME IN SPRINTS FOR INTEGRATION ISSUES

3. SECURITY & DATA PROTECTION RISKS

HANDLING STUDENT DATA MAKES THE PLATFORM VULNERABLE TO ATTACKS OR BREACHES.

MITIGATION:

- PERFORM PENETRATION TESTING AND SYSTEM AUDITS
- IMPLEMENT STRONG AUTHENTICATION (SSO + DUO) AND ENCRYPTED DATA FLOWS
- REGULARLY MONITOR VULNERABILITIES



COMMUNICATION PLAN

1

TEAM COMMUNICATION

- WEEKLY SYNC MEETINGS (FRIDAYS)
- QUICK UPDATES THROUGH SLACK
- SHARED DOCS ON GOOGLE DRIVE

3

ESCALATION PATH

- ADMIN → PROJECT MANAGER → FULL TEAM
- ISSUES RAISED BEFORE SPRINT DEADLINES
- DOCUMENTED IN SHARED TRACKER

2

STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION

- MONTHLY REVIEW MEETINGS
- PROGRESS SUMMARIES IN EMAIL
- EARLY UPDATES BEFORE MILESTONES



PROCUREMENT

PROCUREMENT NEEDS



Technical specialists
for deployment
& troubleshooting



Authentication +
messaging APIs



Cloud hosting
environment and
server infrastructure



Security testing tools
(pen-testing,
vulnerability scans)



User onboarding &
pilot testing materials

QUALITY MANAGEMENT



FUNCTIONAL TESTING

ENSURES EACH MODULE INTERACTS CORRECTLY WITH OTHER PARTS OF THE PLATFORM.

TESTING INCLUDES:

- MODULE-LEVEL VALIDATION
- CROSS-MODULE DATA FLOW CHECKS
- CHAT ↔ ADMIN DASHBOARD COMMUNICATIONS

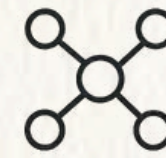


PERFORMANCE TESTING

VERIFIES THAT THE SYSTEM REMAINS STABLE UNDER REAL STUDENT USAGE.

INCLUDES:

- STRESS TESTING DURING PEAK HOURS
- IDENTIFYING BOTTLENECKS BEFORE LAUNCH



CODE REVIEW

IMPROVES QUALITY, CONSISTENCY, AND RELIABILITY OF CODE.

INCLUDES:

- PEER REVIEW OF CORE FEATURES
- VERIFICATION OF SECURE CODING PRACTICES
- REVIEWING API CALLS, SSO FLOW, AND DATA HANDLING
- CHECKING FOR VULNERABILITIES EARLY IN DEVELOPMENT



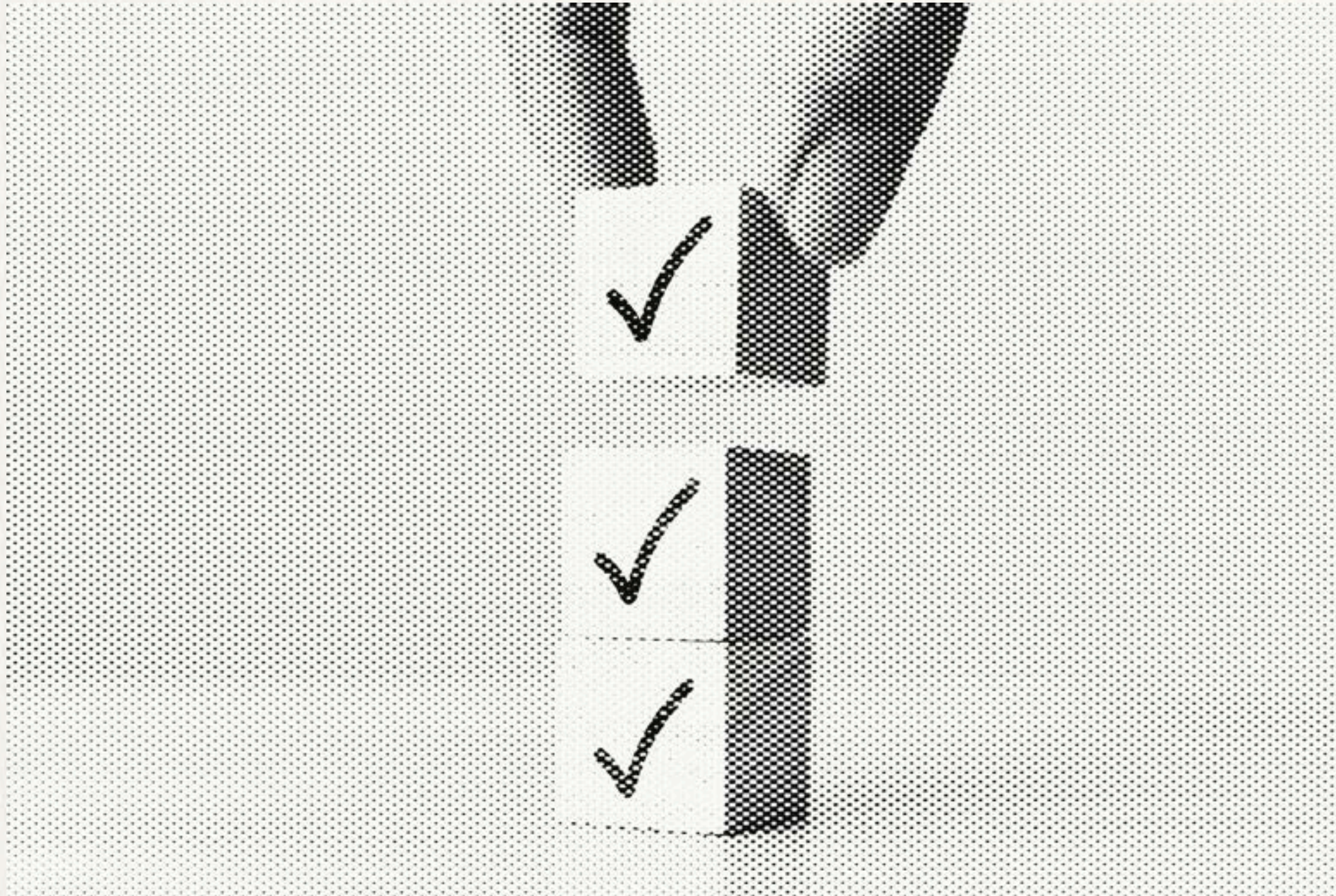
USER ACCEPTANCE TESTING

A PILOT GROUP OF RUTGERS STUDENTS TESTS THE PLATFORM IN REAL SCENARIOS.

INCLUDES:

- GATHERING FEEDBACK ON USABILITY
- FIXING ISSUES BEFORE DEPLOYMENT
- ENSURING THE PLATFORM MATCHES STUDENT NEEDS

CONCLUSION



RUCONNECTED STRENGTHENS STUDENT CONNECTION, IMPROVES RESOURCE ACCESS, AND ENHANCES CAMPUS ENGAGEMENT ACROSS RUTGERS.

A SCALABLE, SECURE SYSTEM READY FOR UNIVERSITY-WIDE ADOPTION.

“CONNECTION
BUILDS COMMUNITY
AND COMMUNITY
BUILDS SUCCESS.”

APPENDIX



BUDGET BREAKDOWN



MILESTONE BREAKDOWN

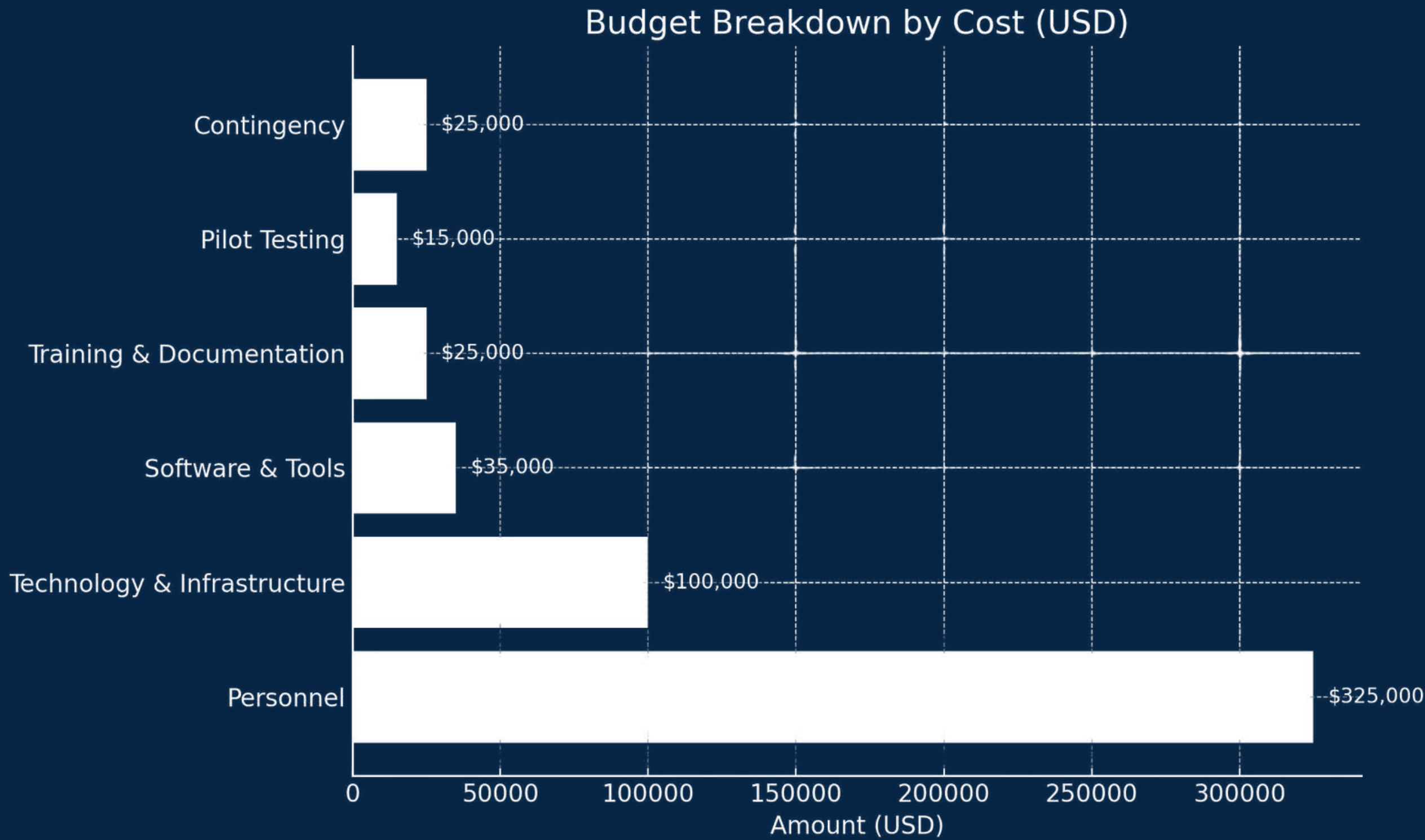


WBS DICTIONARY



PROJECT CHARTER

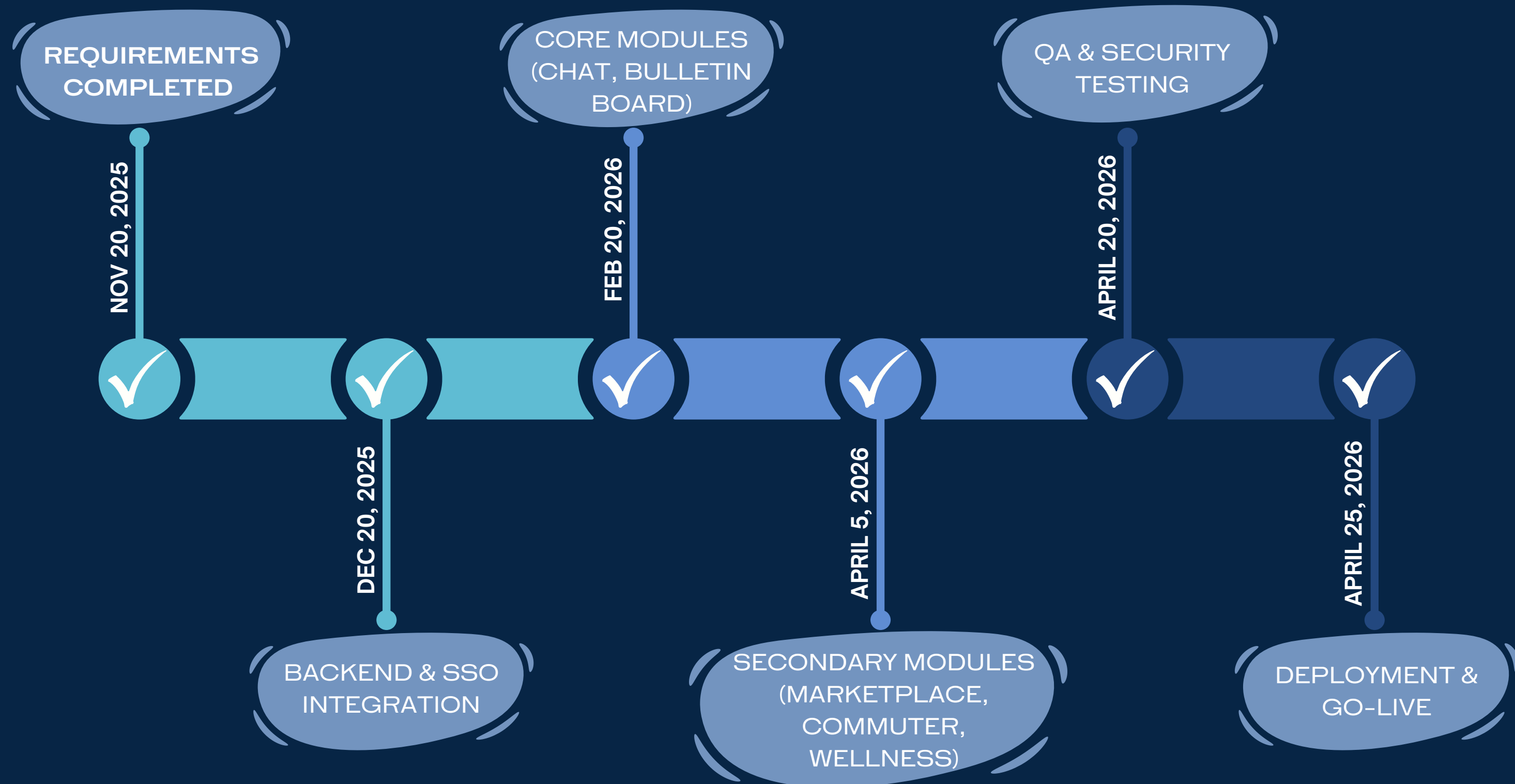
BUDGET BREAKDOWN



**\$500,000
TOTAL BUDGET**

- PERSONNEL — 65%
- TECHNOLOGY — 20%
- TOOLS — 7%
- TRAINING — 5%
- PILOT TESTING — 3%
- CONTINGENCY — 5%

MILESTONES BREAKDOWN



WBS DICTIONARY

Level	Task No.	Name	Description
1		RU-Connected	Project Name
2	1	Platform Development	Phase 1
3	1.1	Requirements	Gather and document all system, user, and business requirements needed for the platform
4	1.1.1	Document System Capabilities	Identify system functions, features, and performance expectations for RU-Connected.
4	1.1.2	Identify Security & Privacy Requirements	Outline compliance needs for student data, Rutgers policies, FERPA, encryption, and access rules
3	1.2	Backend Development	Develop the backend infrastructure, APIs, authentication layers, and data management logic
4	1.2.1	Create Database Schemas	Design logical and physical database structure, including tables, relationships, and data flow.
4	1.2.2	Implement Rutgers SSO	Integrate Rutgers NetID + Duo authentication for secure student/staff login
3	1.3	Frontend Development	Implement the user interface for desktop/mobile experiences using Rutgers branding
3	1.4	Security Framework	Implement the full security architecture for API protection, data protection, and user authorisation
2	2	Core Modules	Phase 2
3	2.1	Chat System	Develop the real-time group messaging and communication module
4	2.1.1	Create public and private channels	Implement the functionality for users to create and manage channels
4	2.1.2	Implement messaging, notifications, and filtering	Build core sending/receiving messages, alerts, and content control features
3	2.2	Bulletin Board	Develop the digital posting board for events, announcements, and student ideas, including upvotes/comments
3	2.3	Admin Dashboard	Develop the interface for moderators and administrators to manage content, users, and view analytics
2	3	Secondary Modules	Phase 3
3	3.1	Commuter Hub	Create a dedicated space for commuters to coordinate rides, find resources, and get campus navigation help

WBS DICTIONARY (CONT.)

3	3.2	Marketplace	Develop the student-to-student listing system for buying/selling textbooks, furniture, etc., including safety features
3	3.3	Wellness Center	Implement a centralised wellness resource directory and peer support access area
2	4	Testing & QA	Phase 4
3	4.1	Module Testing	Verify each module works independently as intended (functional, UX, and mobile responsiveness checks)
3	4.2	System Integration Testing	Ensure all modules work together without errors, including backend/frontend integration and SSO validation
3	4.3	Security Testing	Assess vulnerabilities and confirm compliance with Rutgers security policies.
4	4.3.1	Pen-testing	Conduct penetration testing to identify security flaws
4	4.3.2	Access control validation	Verify that user roles (admin, student) have correct permissions and restrictions
4	4.3.3	Data encryption verification	Confirm that all sensitive data is properly encrypted in transit and at rest
3	4.4	Bug Fixes & Improvements	Resolve all issues identified during testing phases (patch bugs, optimise features)
2	5	Deployment	Phase 5
3	5.1	Configure Servers	Prepare the cloud hosting environment and configure production infrastructure (database deployment, load balancing)
3	5.2	Final Security Checks	Validate that the platform meets all safety and compliance standards for the final launch
3	5.3	Platform Deployment	Release the production version of RU-Connected and initiate the go-live procedures
4	5.3.1	Push code to production	Transfer the final verified code to the live server environment
4	5.3.2	Configure DNS & SSL	Set up domain name resolution and secure socket layer encryption
4	5.3.3	Go-live procedures	Execute the final launch checklist and notify stakeholders
2	6	Documentation & PM	Phase 6
3	6.1	User & Admin Documentation	Document instructions for students and moderators (handbooks and help sections)
3	6.2	Training & Stakeholder Support	Train student workers, IT staff, and campus administrators on platform usage and moderation
3	6.3	Project Management Activities	Manage Agile sprints, team meetings, stakeholder updates, and final project presentation

PROJECT CHARTER

Problem Statement	Rutgers students lack a centralized, university-supported digital platform for academic collaboration, social engagement, and resource sharing. Communication is fragmented across unofficial apps, causing inconsistent information and limited community building.
Business Case	Rutgers students lack a centralized, university-supported digital platform for academic collaboration, social engagement, and resource sharing. Communication is fragmented across unofficial apps, causing inconsistent information and limited community building
Project Management Learning Cycle	Agile Adaptive PMLC – short sprints, iterative releases, continuous feedback, and flexible scope adjustments. This approach fits software development and ensures platform features evolve with student needs
Key Stakeholders	Rutgers IT, Dean of Students, Student Affairs, Mental Wellness Services, Undergraduate & Commuter Students, RU-Connected Project team.
Primary Deliverable	A fully functional RU-Connected website – a centralized, secure, Rutgers-integrated student platform
Secondary Deliverable(s)	Commuter Hub, Student Marketplace, Mental Wellness Resources, Digital Bulletin Board, Chat/Group Channels, Admin Dashboard, Pilot Testing Results, and User Documentation
Scope	
• In-scope	Website development, SSO integration, commuter hub, marketplace, bulletin board, mental health resources, chat, QA testing, and pilot program
• Out-of-scope	Native mobile app, integration with Canvas, AI moderation, external vendor partnerships
Timeline	Nov–Dec 2025: Requirements & design; Jan 2026: Framework; Feb 2026: Core features Mar 2026: Secondary modules; Apr 2026: Pilot testing & launch
Resources	\$500,000 budget; project manager; developers; UI/UX designer; QA tester; cloud hosting; moderation tools; authentication and messaging APIs.
Assumptions	Timely IT support, consistent team availability, and active pilot participation
Risks	Low student adoption, integration delays, security issues, scope creep, and moderation challenges

WE'RE EXCITED TO WORK WITH YOU!
LET'S BRING THIS PROJECT TO LIFE
TOGETHER.

THANK YOU!



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